a phone, after we'd received a letter from someone who had a problem, and telling someone on the staff, "Fix this." That was really a great joy, which will live with me.

I also enjoyed the ceremonial aspects that go with being president. Even after eight years, the experience of walking into a crowded House of Representatives to deliver a speech sent a chill down my spine. Also, nothing thrilled me more than looking up at a wind-blown American flag while listening to a choir sing "The Battle Hymn of the Republic," my favorite song. On overseas trips, I was always moved when I heard our national anthem played at far corners of the world. And I'll never forget standing once in the Vatican after a meeting with Pope John Paul II and hearing a group of Armenian priests singing "America the Beautiful" in as lovely a rendition as I had ever heard it. Nancy and I were both in tears.

There were many, many small moments that made my job fun, such as visiting the modest hideaway of Prime Minister Yasu Nakasone in the woods outside Tokyo and sitting on the floor of this typical Japanese home while we had an authentic Japanese lunch; or landing in a helicopter on the lawn of Windsor Castle for a fairytale visit with Queen Elizabeth and the royal family. The highlight of our stay there came when the queen and I went horseback riding together and Nancy and Prince Philip took a horse-drawn carriage ride. I must admit, the queen is quite an accomplished horsewoman. We will always remember our visit to Windsor Castle because of the queen's and Prince Philip's warmth and welcoming hospitality—they could not have been more gracious. When the queen and Prince Philip later visited us at Rancho del Cielo, it was in February, during the middle of our rainy season, and Santa Barbara was being pummeled by a terrible storm. We waited at the ranch for them while they struggled seven miles up a switchback road. At three places the road was cut by